RUBEN DURANTE

Contact Information

Department of Economics
National University of Singapore
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Citizenship Italian

Academic Positions

National University of Singapore, Department of Economics
Full Professor: 2023- ; Provost's Chair: 2024-

Universitat Pompeu Fabra, Department of Economics and Business
Full Professor: 2021- (on leave)
ICREA Research Professor: 2018 - (on leave)
Associate Professor: 2016 - 2018

Sciences Po, Department of Economics
Associate Professor (with tenure): 2017 - 2018
Assistant Professor: 2010 - 2017

Other Affiliations

Centre for Economic Policy Research (CEPR):
Research Fellow, Political Economy Program (POE);
Member, Research Policy Network on Media Plurality
Member, Research Policy Network on Preventing Conflict: Policies for Peace
Member, Research Policy Network on Migration
CESifo: Research Fellow, Economics of Digitization Area
Institute of Labor Economics (IZA): Research Fellow, Behavioral and Personnel Economics
Asian Bureau of Finance and Economic Research (ABFER): Fellow
Gallup US: Research Advisor
Barcelona School of Economics (BSE): Affiliated Faculty
Institute for Political Economy and Governance (IPEG): Research Associate
Ifo Institute: Research Professor

Visiting Positions

Ifo Institute: July 2024
INSEAD (France): September 2022 to June 2023
Paris School of Economics: September 2022 to June 2023
INSEAD (Singapore): January 2020, February 2021, February 2022
Waseda University, Department of Economics: October 2019
Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, Department of Economics: June 2019
London Business School, Department of Economics: April-May 2019
Brown University, Department of Economics: Summer 2015
Yale University, Dep. of Economics and Leitner Political Economy Program: academic year 2013-14
University of Chicago, Booth School of Business: December 2013
Institute for International Economic Studies, Stockholm: May 2013

Education

Ph.D. Economics, Brown University, 2010
M.A. Economics, Brown University, 2005
M.A. Political Economy, Université de Paris I Panthéon-Sorbonne, 2003
B.A. Economics, Università degli Studi di Messina, 2001

Grants

European Research Council
Consolidator Grant (2025-2030 1.9M €)
Proof of Concept Grant (2023-2025 150k €)
Starting Grant (2018-2024, 1.5M €)

National University of Singapore
Starting Research Grant (2023-2025, 1.57M S$)
BBVA Foundation
Grant for research on COVID-19 in economics and social sciences (2020-2022, 100k €, PI)
Economy and Digital Society Fellowship (2018-2020, 95k €, co-PI)
La Caixa Foundation
Social Research Call 2020 (2020-2022, 100k €, co-PI)
Catalan Agency for the Management of University and Research Grants
Pandèmies 2020 grant (2021-2022, 276k €, co-PI)

Honors and Awards

La Vanguardia-Fundació Catalunya-La Pedrera
Finalist of the 2018 *Vanguardia de la Ciencia* national scientific prize
Spanish Ministry of Education and Research
Ramón y Cajal Fellowship (2017, 2018, declined for conflict with EU funding)
Catalan Agency for Management of University and Research Grants
Beatriu de Pinós Fellowship (2017-2019)
American Economic Association
Prize for Best Paper Published on the *American Economic Journal:Applied Economics* (2017)
Yale University, Georg W. Leitner Program in International and Comparative Political Economy
Visiting Scholar Fellowship (academic year 2013-14)
Brown University, Graduate School
Joukowsky Family Foundation Award for Best Dissertation in the Social Sciences (2011)

Teaching

Political Economy: undergraduate (Sciences Po, Yale, NUS), Master (Sciences Po, UPF), Ph.D. (LBS)
Political Economy of Mass Media: undergraduate (Yale), Master (Sciences Po, Waseda)
Text Analysis for Research in Economics and Finance, Ph.D. (LBS, DIW, UPF, EUI, ULB, King's, Ifo, INSEAD, NUS)
Economics and Business - Public Policy: MBA (INSEAD)
Asia in the Global Economy: EMBA (NUS)
Econometrics: Ph.D. (INSEAD)
Public Economics: undergraduate (Sciences Po, UPF, Yale), Ph.D. (UPF)
Economic Growth and Development: undergraduate (Sciences Po), Master (UPF)
Topics in Experimental and Behavioral Economics: Master (Sciences Po)

Professional Experience

Inter-American Development Bank (IADB)
Consultant (July 2019 -)

Columbia University, CPC Learning Network, Program on Forced Migration and Health
Consultant (April 2019 - July 2019)

World Bank (WBIPR)
Consultant (September 2006 to August 2007); Intern (Summer 2006)

Published Papers

Party Politics, Inter-jurisdictional Cooperation and Law Enforcement: Evidence from Mexico (with E. Depetris-Chauvín and E. Gutierrez), *Journal of Public Economics*, 2025, vol. 252, p.105513.

Calamities, Common Interests, Shared Identity: what Shapes Social Cohesion in Europe? (with C. Aksoy, A. Cabrales, M. Dolls, L. Windsteiger), *Journal of Comparative Economics*, 2025, vol. 53, n. 4, pp. 1049-1068.

Lost in the Net? Broadband Internet and Youth Mental Health (with D. Donati, F. Sobbrio, and D. Zejcirovic), *Journal of Health Economics*, 2025, vol. 103, p.103017.

Unpacking Social Capital (with N. Mastrorocco, L. Minale, J. Snyder), *The Economic Journal*, 2025, vol. 135, n. 667, pp. 773–807.

The Impact of Online Competition on Newspaper: Evidence from the Introduction of Craigslist (with

G. Martin, M. Djourelova), *The Review of Economic Studies*, 2025, vol. 92, n. 3, pp. 1738–1772.

Media Slant and Public Policy Views (with M. Djourelova, E. Motte, and E. Patacchini), *American Economic Review: Papers & Proceedings*, 2024, vol. 114, pp. 684-689.

The Virus of Fear: The Political Impact of Ebola in the U.S. (with E. Depetris-Chauvín and F. Campante), *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 2024, vol. 16, n.1, pp. 480-509.

Salience and Accountability: School Infrastructure and Last-Minute Electoral Punishment (with N. Ajzenmán), *The Economic Journal*, 2023, vol. 133, n. 649, pp. 460–476.

Media and Social Capital (with F. Campante and A. Tesei), *Annual Review of Economics*, 2022, vol. 14, pp. 69-91.

Real-Time Inequality and the Welfare State in Motion: Evidence from Covid-19 in Spain (with O. Aspachs, J. Montalvo, A. Graziano, J. Mestres, M. Reynal-Querol), *Economic Policy*, 2022, vol. 37, n. 109, pp. 165-199.

Media Attention and Strategic Timing in Politics: Evidence from U.S. Presidential Executive Orders (with M. Djourelova), *American Journal of Political Science*, October 2021, 1-22.

Internal Migration Networks and Mortality in Home Communities: Evidence from Italy during the Covid-19 Pandemic (with M. Valsecchi), *European Economic Review*, 2021, vol. 140, 103890.

Tracking the Impact of COVID-19 on Economic Inequality at High Frequency (with O. Aspachs, J. Montalvo, A. Graziano, J. Mestres, M. Reynal-Querol), *PLOS ONE*, 2021, vol. 16, n.3.

Asocial Capital: Civic Culture and Social Distancing During COVID-19 (with L. Guiso and G. Gulino), *Journal of Public Economics*, 2021, vol. 194, p. 104342.

Risk, Cooperation and the Co-Evolution of Culture and Institutions (with J. Buggle), *The Economic Journal*, 2021, vol. 131, n. 637, pp. 1947-1987.

Advertising Spending and Media Bias: Evidence from News Coverage of Car Safety Recalls (with R. G. Beattie, B. Knight, A. Sen), *Management Science*, 2021, vol. 67, n.2, pp. 698-719.

Building Nations through Shared Experiences: Evidence from African Football (with E. Depetris-Chauvín, F. Campante) *American Economic Review*, 2020, vol. 110, n. 5, pp. 1572-1602.

The Political Legacy of Entertainment TV (with P. Pinotti, A. Tesei) *American Economic Review*, 2019, vol. 109, n. 7, pp. 2497-2530.

Attack when the World is not Watching? U.S. Media and the Israeli-Palestinian Conflict (with E. Zhuravskaya) *Journal of Political Economy*, 2018, vol. 126, n. 3, pp. 1085-1133.

Politics 2.0: the Multifaceted Effect of Broadband Internet on Political Participation (with F. Campante, F. Sobbrio) *Journal of the European Economic Association*, 2018, vol. 16, n. 4, pp. 1094–1136.

Market-Based Lobbying: Evidence from Advertising Spending in Italy (with S. DellaVigna, E. La Ferrara, B. Knight) *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 2016, vol. 8, n.1, pp. 224-56.

Poor Institutions, Rich Mines: Resource Curse in the Origins of the Sicilian Mafia (with P. Buonanno, P. Vanin, G. Prarolo) *The Economic Journal*, 2015, vol. 125, n. 586.

Preferences for Redistribution and Perception of Fairness: an Experimental Study (with L. Putterman, J. van der Weele) *Journal of the European Economic Association*, 2014, vol. 12, n. 4.

Partisan Control, Media Bias, and Viewer Responses: Evidence from Berlusconi's Italy (with B. Knight) *Journal of the European Economic Association*, 2012, vol. 10, n. 3.

Edited Volumes

The Political Economy of Social Media (with F. Campante, A. Tesei), CEPR Ebook, 2023.

Book Chapters

One Team, One Nation: Football, Identity and Conflict in Africa (with F. Campante, E. Depetris-Chauvín), in "Nation Building: Big Lessons from Successes and Failures", edited by D. Rohner and E. Zhuravskaya, CEPR, 2023.

Progressivity of Taxes, Corporate Tax, and Estate Tax (with L. Putterman), in "Improving Public Opinion Surveys", edited by J. H. Aldrich and K. M. McGraw, Princeton University Press, 2012.

Working Papers

GenAI Misinformation, Trust, and News Consumption: Evidence from a Field Experiment (with

F. Campante, F. Hagemeister, and A. Sen), NBER WP #34100, Resubmitted *Journal of Political Economy*.

Visual Representation and Stereotypes in News Media (with E. Ash, M. Grebenshchikova, and C. Schwartz), CEPR Discussion Paper #16624, Resubmitted *The Economic Journal*.

Experience, Narratives, and Climate Change Beliefs (with M. Djourelova, E. Motte, and E. Patacchini), CEPR DP #18738, Revise & Resubmit *Journal of the European Economic Association*.

Media Capture by Banks (with A. Fabiani, L. Laeven, and J.-L. Peydró), CEPR DP #14702.

The Anatomy of Censorship and Propaganda: Evidence from Russian Wikipedias (with V. Avetian, U. Matter, and E. Zhuravskaya), CEPR DP #21698.

Platform Power of News Aggregators (with A. Simonov, D. Mikhailov, and R. Enikolopov).

Research in Progress

Political Beliefs and Labor Market Decisions (with N. Ajzenmán and E. Teso)

Coordinating Voters Better: How Polls Count Votes and Make Votes Count (with F. Capozza, and S. George)

China Goes Hollywood (with J. Mueller, K. Mueller, C. Schwartz)

The Atlas of Social Capital (with N. Mastrorocco, L. Minale, J. Snyder).

Who believes in Conspiracy Theories and Why (with D. Acemoglu, C. Aksoy, and S. Sequeira).

Paywalls, Information Inequities, and Polarization.

Citations

Google Scholar: 5136 citations, h-index: 26

Keynote Lectures

9th Economics of Media Bias Workshop (Berlin, 2026)

8th Madrid Political Economy Workshop (Madrid, 2025)

CESifo Summer Institute Workshop on Digital Platforms: Policy and Politics (Venice, 2025)

CESifo 2023 Political Economy Workshop (Dresden, 2023)

Australian Political Economy Workshop (Melbourne, 2023)

European Public Choice Society Meeting 2023 (Hannover, 2023)

Annual Congress of the Swiss Society of Economics and Statistics (Fribourg, 2022)

Workshop on Governance of Big Data and Artificial Intelligence (Tilburg, 2019)

Third Economics of Media Bias Conference (Cologne, 2018)

Conferences

4th CEPR Workshop on Media, Technology, Politics, and Society (Rome, 2026); IESE Conference on the Economics of AI (Barcelona, 2026); CEPR Paris Symposium 2025 (Paris, 2025); 29th Annual Conference of the Society for Institutional and Organizational Economics (Sydney, 2025); 3rd CEPR Workshop on Media, Technology, Politics, and Society (Milan, 2025); 17th Digital Economics Conference (Toulouse, January 2025); EJPE-CEPR Political Economy Conference (Naples, 2024); Polarize Conference 2024 (Bergen, 2024); CEPR 2023 Paris Symposium (Paris, 2023); Narratives in Economics Workshop (Zurich, 2023); CEPR-Dortmund Political Economy Workshop on Democracy and Policy Implementation (Dortmund, 2023); 73rd Economic Policy Panel (online, 2021); Monash-Warwick-Zurich Text-as-Data Workshop (online, 2020); NBER Political Economy 2020 Fall Workshop (online, 2020); 1stLondon Political Finance Workshop (online, 2020); Workshop on Elections, Democracy, and Populism (Bologna, 2020); 2nd UZH Workshop on Political Economy and Development (Zurich, 2019); 2018 University of Chile Political Economy & Political Science Workshop (Santiago, 2018), 2018 UK Political Economy Workshop (Bath, 2018); 2018 Economics of Media and Communications Conference (Chicago, 2018); Political Economy of Conflict and Development Workshop (Villars, 2018); 2017 NBER Summer Institute in Development (Boston, 2017); 2017 NBER Summer Institute in Industrial Organization (Boston, 2017); 2017 International Economic Association Conference (Mexico City, 2017); Conference on the Economics of Intellectual Property, Software and the Internet (Toulouse, 2017); 14th Workshop on Media Economics (Zurich, 2016); 2016 Barcelona Summer Forum (Barcelona, 2016); 2015 Media and Communication Conference (Chicago, 2015); EEA 2015 Conference (Mannheim, 2015); Economics of Media Bias Conference (Hamburg, 2015); Conference on the Economics of Intellectual Property, Software and the Internet (Toulouse, 2015); 12th Workshop on Media Economics (Naples, 2014); 2014 NEUDC Conference (Boston, 2014); Yale Center for the Study of American Politics 2014

Workshop (New Haven, 2014); Midwest Political Science Association (Chicago, 2014); AEA 2013 Annual Meeting (San Diego, 2013); 10th Workshop on Media Economics (Bogotá, 2012); Conference on the Economics of Interactions and Culture (Rome, 2012); Workshop on the Economics of Crime and Corruption (Namur, 2012); Applied Economics Workshop (Petralia Sottana, 2011); NBER 2011 Summer Institute DAE (Boston, 2011); Midwest Economic Association 2010 Annual Meeting (Evanston, 2010); CEPR Conference on "Economics of Culture, Institutions, and Crime" (Milan, 2010); 5th Royal Economic Society Ph.D. Presentation Meeting (London, 2010); NEUDC Conference (Boston, 2009); Workshop on "Political Economy and the Environment" (Louvain-la-Neuve, 2009); 2nd Conference on Early Economic Developments (Vancouver, 2009); LACEA Political Economy Group Meeting (Cartagena, 2009); 6th Workshop on Media Economics (Zurich, 2008); 2nd Meeting of the Society for the Study of Economic Inequality (Berlin, 2007).

Invited Seminars

University of Oxford (Oxford, scheduled); King's College London (London, scheduled); QMUL (London, scheduled); Nova School of Business and Economics (Lisbon, scheduled); New York University (Abu Dhabi, 2026); Università della Svizzera Italiana (Lugano, scheduled); Central European University (Vienna, 2025); University of Vienna (Vienna, 2025); Hong Kong University (Hong Kong, 2025); Bocconi University (Milan, 2025); ETH Zurich (Zurich, 2025); University of Bern (Bern, 2025); University of Bologna (Bologna, 2025); University of Rome Tor Vergata (Rome, 2025); Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Hong Kong, 2024); Université Libre de Bruxelles (Bruxelles, 2025); London School of Economics Management (London, 2024); University of Warwick (Coventry, 2024); ESADE (Barcelona, 2024); University of Geneva (Geneva, 2023); University of St. Gallen (St. Gallen, 2023); Lee Kuan Yew School of Public Policy (Singapore, 2023); Norwegian School of Economics (Bergen, 2023); National University of Singapore (Singapore, 2022, 2020); Yale University (New Haven, 2022, 2014, 2013); Brown University (Providence, 2022, 2012, 2009); Harvard Kennedy School (Cambridge, 2022); Paris School of Economics (Paris, 2022, 2016, 2012, 2011); CREST-Polytechnique (Paris, 2022, 2011); Università Cattolica del Sacro Cuore (online, 2021); Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance (Rome, 2021, 2018, 2013); LUISS (Rome, 2021); University of Pittsburgh (online, 2021); INSEAD (Paris, 2021 & 2015); SciencesPo/PSE (Paris, 2021); Stanford GSE (online, 2021); Bocconi (online, 2021); London School of Economics PSPE Seminar (online, 2021); University of Mannheim (online, 2020); Banca d'Italia (online, 2020); WZB Institutions and Political Inequality Seminar (online, 2020); ESSEC Business School (Paris, 2020); Virtual IO Seminar (online, 2020); IMF ICD Seminar (online, 2020); Johns Hopkins University (Washington D.C., 2019); Waseda University (Tokyo, 2019); Università della Svizzera Italiana (Lugano, 2019); Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile (Santiago, 2019); European Commission, ECFIN (Bruxelles, 2019); University of Zurich (Zurich, 2019); Central European University (Budapest, 2019); Berlin Applied Microeconomics Seminar (Berlin, 2019); Bank of Italy (Rome, 2018); Boston University (Boston, 2018); Universidad Carlos III (Madrid, 2018, 2011); Collegio Carlo Alberto (Turin, 2018); Ludwig Maximilian University (Munich, 2017), Université Libre de Bruxelles (Bruxelles, 2017); London Business School (London, 2017); CEMFI (Madrid, 2017), European University Institute (Florence, 2017); Universidad Autonoma de Barcelona (Barcelona, 2017); University of Lausanne (Lausanne, 2016); Inter-American Development Bank (Washington D.C., 2016, 2010); New York City Media Seminar (New York, 2016); Universitat Pompeu Fabra (Barcelona, 2016 & 2011); Toulouse School of Economics (Toulouse, 2016, 2014, 2011); Bocconi University (Milan, 2015, 2012, 2009); University of Toronto (Toronto, 2015); NYU Abu Dhabi (Abu Dhabi, 2015); Stockholm University (Stockholm, 2015); Queen Mary University (London, 2015); UCLA Anderson (Los Angeles, 2015); UCSB (Santa Barbara, 2015); Harris School of Public Policy (Chicago, 2015); Aix-Marseille School of Economics (Marseille, 2015); University of Mannheim (Mannheim, 2015); London School of Economics (London, 2014); New York University (New York, 2014 & 2012); World Bank (Washington D.C., 2014); Hunter College CUNY (New York, 2014); University of Warwick (Coventry, 2014); Booth School of Business (Chicago, 2013); Tufts University (Somerville, 2013); Harvard University (Cambridge, 2013); Université de Namur (Namur, 2013); IIES Stockholm (Stockholm, 2013); WZB Berlin (Berlin, 2012); Université de Paris Panthéon Sorbonne (Paris, 2012); Dartmouth College (Hanover, 2012); Universidad de Los Andes (Bogotà, 2012); CSEF (Naples, 2012); Goethe University (Frankfurt, 2012); University of Rotterdam (Rotterdam, 2012); Stockholm School of Economics (Stockholm, 2011, 2012); New School of Economics (Moscow, 2011); IAE-CSIC (Barcelona, 2011); Graduate Institute (Geneva, 2011); Max Planck Institute for Research on Collective Goods (Bonn, 2011); Université Catholique de Louvain (Louvain-la-Neuve, 2010); Universidad de Alicante (Alicante, 2010); IMT (Lucca, 2010 & 2009); Université du Québec à Montreal (Montreal, 2010); Essex (Colchester, 2010); Sciences Po (Paris, 2010); University of Colorado Boulder (Boulder, 2010); Università di Bologna (Bologna, 2009); University of Copenhagen (Copenhagen, 2009).

Editorial Service

Associate editor: *The Economic Journal* (2024-), *Journal of the European Economic Association* (2017-19), *European Economic Review* (2019-2021)

Member of the editorial panel: *Economic Policy* (2018-2020)

Referee: *American Economic Review, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Econometrica, Journal of Political Economy, Review of Economic Studies, Journal of the European Economic Association, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, American Economic Review: Insights, Science, Journal of Political Economy: Micro, Economic Journal, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Economic Growth, Journal of Development Economics, European Economic Review, European Journal of Political Economy, Economic Policy, RAND Journal of Economics, Proceedings of the National Academy of Science, American Journal of Political Science, American Political Science Review, Quarterly Journal of Political Science, Journal of Economic Psychology, Journal of Comparative Economics, Journal of Economic Inequality, Economic Letters, The Economics of Transition, Political Communication*

Referee Prize (*The Economic Journal*, 2024)

Supervisions

Research assistants: Christine Cai (Princeton, Ph.D.), Laura Litvine (UCL, Ph.D.), Giovanni Sciacovelli (Northwestern, Ph.D.), Héctor Paredes Castro (PSE, Ph.D.), David Ampudia Vicente (UPF, Masters in Data Science), Marco Lo Faso (USC, Ph.D.), Eduardo Espuny (CEMFI, Masters), Nikola Kiprijanovski (INSEAD, Ph.D. in Finance), Mariia Grebenshchikova (TU Munich, Masters in Data Science), Saumya Vaishnava (Penn State, Ph.D. in Geography), Gyorgy Ruzsicka (CEU, Ph.D.), Giulia Tosetti (ECB, Analyst), Vivian Liu (LSE, Ph.D. in Geography), David Vilalta (Columbia, Ph.D. in Political Science), Lorena Mita (University of Geneva, Ph.D.), Alessandro Izzo (Boston College, Ph.D.), Simone Genetin (Brown University, Ph.D.)

Ph.D. students (*main advisor): Elliot Motte* (UNSW, postdoc; ENSAI, assistant professor), Christoph Semken* (Stanford postdoc; University of Toronto, assistant professor), Dante Donati (Columbia Business School, assistant professor), Milena Djourelova* (Chicago, postdoc; USC, assistant professor), Alessio Romarri (Bocconi, postdoc; University of Barcelona, assistant professor), Andrea Fabiani (Bank of Italy, economist), Nicolas Ajzenmán* (McGill, assistant professor), Johannes Buggle (University of Innsbruck, assistant professor), Iván Torre* (World Bank, senior economist), Eve Colson-Shira (Hebrew University, assistant professor).

Postdocs: Giorgio Gulino (University of Rome Tor Vergata, assistant professor).

Professional service

Co-organizer of the CEPR Political Economy Symposium (2025, 2026)

Co-organizer of the CEPR Workshop on Media, Technology, Politics, and Society (2022-2026)

Co-organizer of the Political Economy Workshop at Barcelona Summer Forum (2017-2026)

Organizer of the UPF Labor, Public and Development Seminar (2016-17, 2019-2022)

Founder and co-organizer of the Paris Empirical Political Economy Seminar (2012-16)

Co-organizer of the Sciences Po Department of Economics Student Lunch Seminar (2014-16)

Co-organizer of the Sciences Po Department of Economics weekly Research Seminar (2011-12)

Member of the Junior Faculty Recruitment Committee, Sciences Po Econ Department (2011-12)

External service

External evaluator: European Research Council (x3), The Leverhulme Trust, German Research Foundation, Swiss Research Foundation, Riksbankens Jubileumsfond, Dutch Research Council, Chilean Science Foundation, Belgian Science Foundation, Spanish Research Agency, KU Leuven.

External thesis evaluator: Warwick University, École Polytechnique/CREST, EUI (x2), University of Essex, LSE (x2), University of Oslo, Bocconi University (x2), Université de Lausanne, Sciences Po, EHESS/PSE (x2), Aix-Marseille School of Economics, University of Padua, Trinity College Dublin.

Membership

European Economics Association, American Economic Association, Latin American and Caribbean Economic Association, American Political Science Association, European Political Science Association

Languages

Italian (native), English (fluent), Spanish (fluent), French (fluent)